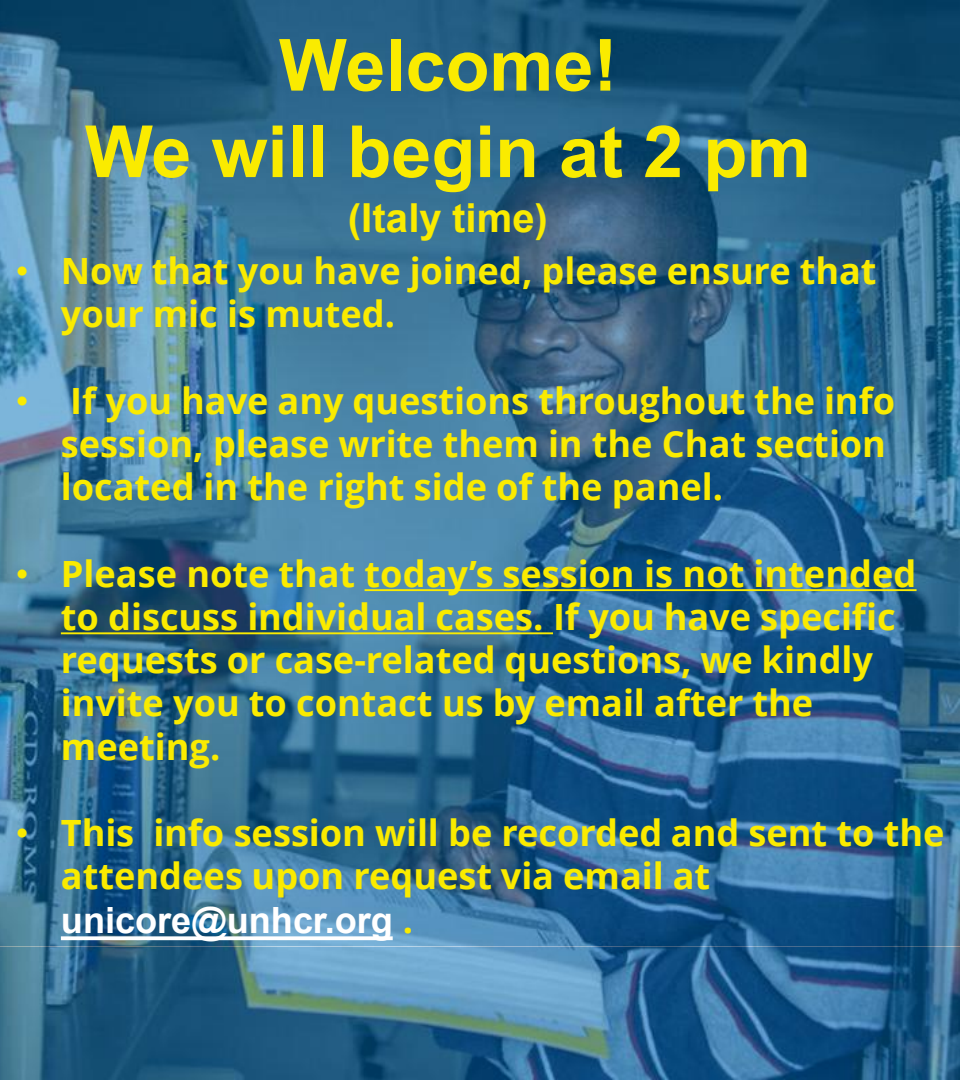




Welcome!

We will begin at 2 pm

(Italy time)

- Now that you have joined, please ensure that your mic is muted.
- If you have any questions throughout the info session, please write them in the Chat section located in the right side of the panel.
- Please note that today's session is not intended to discuss individual cases. If you have specific requests or case-related questions, we kindly invite you to contact us by email after the meeting.
- This info session will be recorded and sent to the attendees upon request via email at unicore@unhcr.org.

Enhancing the UNICORE Experience

Key Findings from the 2026 Student
Survey

Agenda

- Welcome and introduction

UNHCR

- Presentation of the 2026 UNICORE Student Survey findings

UNHCR

- UNICORE Students Committee: reflections on the survey findings

Duol Deng Diew-UNICORE Students Committee

- Staying connected: UNICORE alumni and student database update

Chiara Burzotta - UNHCR

- Open discussion and Q&A

- Closing remarks and next steps

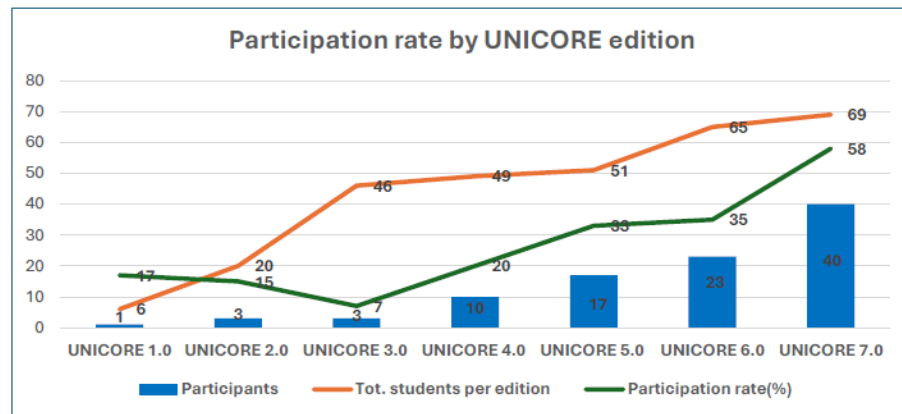




UNICORE 2026 student survey

Key findings

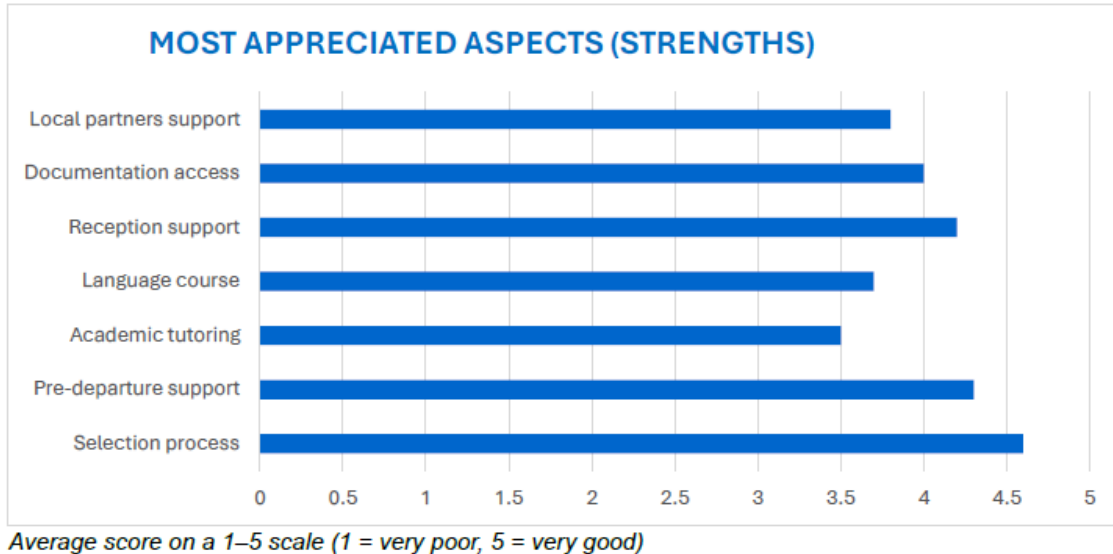
- Insights from **97 students and alumni** across 7 UNICORE editions
- Survey conducted between April and May 2026
- Participation rate: **35%**





What's working well

- High appreciation for the **selection process**
- Strong **pre-departure and post-arrival support**
- Positive feedback on **reception and initial integration**
- Overall **strong trust and satisfaction** with the programme



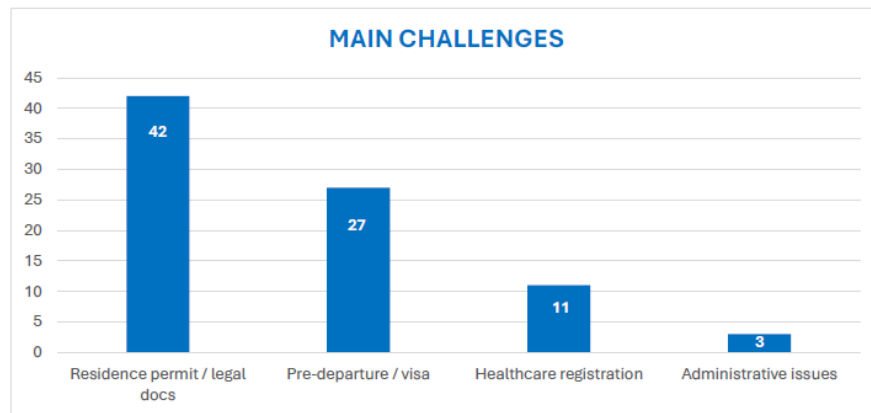


Digital experience

- Clear and transparent **selection and application process**
- Accessible and **user-friendly information channels**
- Positive experience with **UNICORE platform and calls**

! Areas for improvement

- **Financial support** and cost of living pressures
- **Documentation** delays and administrative challenges
- **Language barriers** affecting academic experience
- Access to **healthcare and wellbeing** support



Values represent the number of times each challenge was reported by respondents. Multiple responses per participant were allowed.



Financial pressure

- Financial support often **sufficient in principle but insufficient in practice**
- Delays in stipend disbursement reported
- Rising living costs affecting students in major cities
- Direct impact on **academic performance and wellbeing**

“Sometimes we receive the stipend months late, and this creates a lot of pressure.”



Mental health and wellbeing

- Wellbeing strongly linked to financial and administrative stress
- Uneven access to **healthcare and psychosocial support**
- Need for more structured **mental health support systems**

“Financial stress, academic pressure and uncertainty all impact our mental health.”

Discrimination and belonging

- Mixed experiences across universities and cities
- Reports of discrimination and social exclusion
- Need for safe and accessible **reporting mechanisms**

- ZERO TOLERANCE APPROACH
- Please report eventual episodes to partners and UNHCR

Post-graduation and future prospects

“Education alone is not enough if there are no opportunities afterwards.”

- The transition after graduation is the **most critical gap**
- Uncertainty about **employment opportunities**
- Concerns about **legal status and long-term stability**
- Perceived “**cliff effect**” at the end of the programme



Recommendations

- Strengthen **post-graduation pathways**(career support, internships, mentorship, alumni networks)
- Improve **documentation processes** (residence permits, coordination with institutions)
- Review **financial support models**(timeliness, adequacy, harmonisation)
- Enhance **language and academic support**
- Expand **wellbeing and protection services**

Next steps

- ✓ Share findings with **students, universities and partners**
- ✓ Organise **dedicated discussion sessions**
- ✓ Feed results into **future programme planning**
- ✓ Launch **follow-up survey for universities and partners**
- ✓ Continue coordination with **UNHCR operations and partners**

Staying connected!

Help us keep the UNICORE community strong

What is this survey?

- ✓ A collection of information on where you currently are in your academic and professional journey.
- ✓ A way to keep our database up to date.
- ✓ A tool that helps us understand who, and how many of you, could benefit from support during the post-graduation phase.

Why? Because YOU asked for it!

- In the previous survey, many of you identified the transition to employment as one of the main gaps in the UNICORE programme.



Staying connected!

Help us keep the UNICORE community strong

Why are we asking for this update?

- ✓ To stay in touch with UNICORE students and alumni
- ✓ To better understand graduates' academic and professional pathways
- ✓ To identify opportunities for future support, networking and alumni engagement
- ✓ To improve UNICORE for future cohorts
- ✓ To make sure we can reach you when opportunities arise

The survey takes only 3–5 minutes.

[UNICORE alumni & student survey – Compilation](#)





Grazie!

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